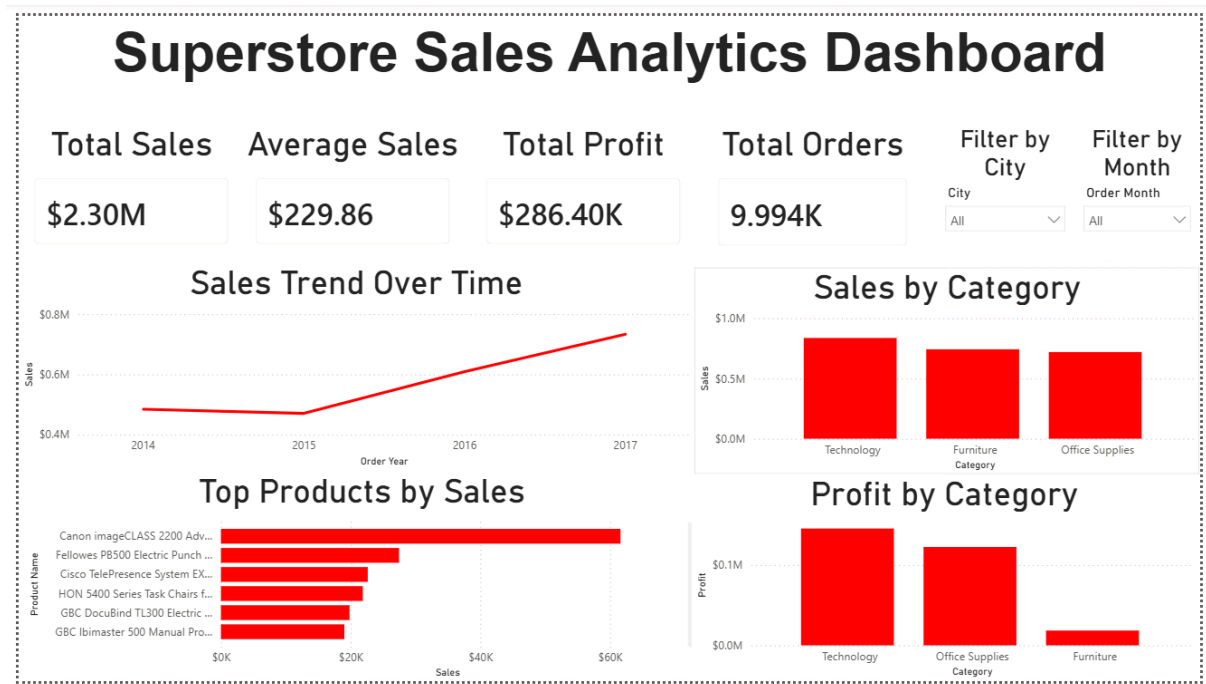


SUPERSTORE SALES PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS

DASHBOARD



CONTEXT

Businesses generate large amounts of sales data every day, but raw data alone cannot help in decision-making unless it is properly analyzed and visualized. This project focuses on analyzing Superstore sales data to identify important business trends, profitable categories, high-performing products, and overall sales growth. Using Excel and Power BI, the raw sales dataset was cleaned, transformed, and converted into an interactive dashboard that provides meaningful business insights and supports data-driven decision-making.

DATASET INFORMATION

- Dataset: Superstore Sales Dataset
- Source: Kaggle
- Records Analyzed: ~9,994 orders
- Time Period: 2014-2017

OBJECTIVE

The objective of this project was to analyze business sales data and create an interactive sales analytics dashboard to identify:

- Revenue trends over time
- Top-performing products
- Most profitable categories
- Business growth opportunities
- Sales and profit patterns
- Key business insights for better decision-making

The dashboard was designed to help businesses understand their performance clearly and make informed strategic decisions.

TOOLS USED

- Microsoft Excel
- Power BI

PROJECT WORKFLOW

- Imported the raw sales dataset into Microsoft Excel and created a separate cleaned dataset for analysis
- Cleaned and organized the data by formatting values, handling inconsistencies, and extracting Year and Month from order dates
- Loaded the cleaned dataset into Power BI for visualization and analysis
- Created an interactive dashboard with KPI cards, slicers, and multiple charts to analyze sales trends, categories, products, and profits
- Formatted and optimized the dashboard layout by improving readability, alignment, labels, and overall presentation
- Generated business insights and recommendations based on sales performance, profitability, and product analysis

KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS (KPIs)

- Total Sales: \$2.30M
- Average Sales: \$229.86
- Total Profit: \$286.40K
- Total Orders: 9.994K

KEY INSIGHTS

1. The business showed strong growth between 2014 and 2017. Total sales increased from approximately \$484K in 2014 to around \$733K in 2017, representing an overall growth of more than 50% over four years.
2. Sales experienced a slight decline of around 2.9% in 2015. However, the company recovered strongly in 2016 with approximately 27.7% growth, followed by another major increase of about 22.2% in 2017.
3. The Technology category emerged as the best-performing category with approximately:
 - \$836K in total sales
 - \$145K in total profitDespite having fewer orders than Office Supplies, Technology generated significantly higher revenue and profitability per order.
4. Furniture category had high sales but very low profit. Furniture generated around \$742K in sales but only about \$18K in profit. This indicates possible issues such as:
 - high operational costs
 - heavy discounts
 - low profit margins
 - inefficient pricing strategiesThis was one of the most critical findings from the analysis.
5. Office Supplies had the highest number of orders with approximately 6,000 orders. Although the average order value was lower, the category generated stable revenue and strong overall profitability.
6. Products such as the “Canon ImageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier” generated very high revenue and profit despite having only a few orders. This suggests that premium products contribute significantly to overall business performance.
7. The “HON 5400 Series Task Chairs for Big and Tall” generated approximately \$21.87K in sales but almost zero profit. This indicates that certain products may be reducing overall profitability due to poor pricing or high associated costs.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Increase Investment in Technology Products

Since the Technology category generated the highest sales and profit, the business should focus more on:

- marketing technology products
- expanding product offerings
- increasing inventory for high-demand technology items

2. Improve Furniture Profitability

The Furniture category requires immediate attention. The business should:

- review pricing strategies
- reduce unnecessary discounts
- optimize shipping and operational costs
- evaluate low-performing products

3. Promote High-Profit Premium Products

High-value products such as the “Canon ImageCLASS 2200 Advanced copier” should be promoted more aggressively because they contribute significantly to revenue and profit.

4. Monitor Low-Profit Products

Products generating low or zero profit should be carefully analyzed to determine whether:

- pricing needs adjustment
- supplier costs need renegotiation
- or the products should be discontinued

5. Use City and Month Filters for Better Planning

The dashboard slicers can help businesses identify:

- high-performing cities
- seasonal sales trends
- peak demand periods

This can improve marketing strategies, inventory planning, and sales forecasting.

INTERPRETATION

The dashboard analysis clearly shows that the business experienced strong long-term growth and increasing customer demand between 2014 and 2017. The steady rise in sales after 2015 indicates successful business recovery and expansion. The company generated approximately \$2.30 million in total sales and nearly \$286K in profit, reflecting strong overall business performance.

The analysis also highlights that the Technology category is the company’s strongest business segment. It generated the highest revenue and profit despite having fewer total orders compared to Office Supplies. This suggests that customers purchasing technology products tend to make higher-value purchases, making the category highly profitable for the business.

On the other hand, the Furniture category revealed a major profitability concern. Although Furniture generated strong sales revenue, the profit remained extremely low. This indicates that high sales alone do not guarantee business success if operational costs, discounts, or pricing strategies are not managed effectively.

The dashboard also demonstrates the importance of product-level analysis. Certain products generated very high sales and profits with only a few orders, while some products generated revenue without contributing meaningful profit. These findings can help businesses make smarter decisions regarding product strategy, pricing, and future investments.

CONCLUSION

This project successfully transformed raw sales data into a professional and interactive business analytics dashboard using Excel and Power BI. The analysis provided valuable insights into sales trends, category performance, profitability, and product-level performance. The dashboard not only helped identify business strengths and growth opportunities but also highlighted important profitability issues that require attention. Overall, the project demonstrates how data analytics and visualization can support better business decision-making and improve organizational performance through data-driven insights.

LINKS

Github Link

https://github.com/nayanans007/FUTURE_DS_01

Superstore Sales Data - Kaggle

[Superstore Sales Data](#)

Superstore Dataset Raw (Microsoft Excel)

[SuperstoreData_raw.xlsx](#)

Superstore Dataset Cleaned (Microsoft Excel)

[SuperstoreData_cleaned.xlsx](#)

Superstore Sales Analysis Dashboard (Power BI)

[Superstore Sales Analysis Dashboard](#)

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